
A guide to
careers in UX Design

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The UX Handbook is a quick guide to help you gain awareness about UX Design as a profession, to help you prepare for a career in this field, and to know more about the role of UX designers and their work.

Understanding UX Design

What is UX Design?

Very simply put, User Experience (UX) Design aims at creating products/services that are easy to use, intuitive and driven by the needs and requirements of the end users. If users are able to interact with your product effortlessly and meaningfully, they are more likely to find value in your offering, adopt it, and recommend it.

UX Design, however, is not merely about design. It draws inputs from diverse fields such as cognitive psychology, research, business, and, of course, technology. These inputs converge into creating designs – and consequently experiences – that users find easy, valuable, and pleasant to interact with.

What does a UX Designer really do?

That's a tough question! Practicing UX Design professionals also find themselves at a loss when asked to explain their daily work, because their role is so complex and multifaceted.

Primarily, UX Designers concern themselves with making products and technology usable and enjoyable, and for this, their focal point is the end user. While designing a new product, making changes to an existing one, or even adding a new feature, UX Designers must prioritize users and their interaction.

Having said that, UX Designers also need to take into cognizance business goals and objectives. It will be fair to say that they work at the intersection of business and user requirements and successfully address both if they want the product to succeed.

The field of UX Design is interesting and challenging because of the wide variety of activities UX professionals do. Here is a short list of common activities regardless of the product or domain. These include:

UX Strategy

User Research

Ecosystem Research

Persona Creation

Information Architecture

Structural and Detailed Design

Wireframing & Prototyping

Usability Testing and Validation

Emotional Design

Design Documentation

Who can become a UX Designer and what skills/knowledge does one need?

If you're looking to do work that requires you to be creative, solve complex problems and be empathetic, then UX Design could be perfect for you. Your core work will be to build systems and equipment that are easy for people to use in terms of speed and accuracy, minimal training requirements, and satisfaction and safety.

While this multi-disciplinary field draws people from computer science, visual design, product design, marketing, psychology, sociology, research, and even architecture, a foundational knowledge to do core usability work is essential. Over and above this skill-based knowledge, a good UX Designer must be able to empathize with users and understand how

humans behave. An industry-recognized certification can help you acquire baseline capabilities as well as knowledge of advanced UX topics. It helps you build credibility because you understand the language and the concepts. It also fortifies you with the expertise to provide the rationale behind your design choices to the client and management.

Empathy, logical reasoning, an analytical bent of mind, awareness about technology (both current and future trends), good communication and presentation skills along with foundational UX Design knowledge are the arsenal you will need to succeed in this field.



Benefits of HFI Usability Training

Usability Training

Considered the gold standard in UX training, our unique and relevant training provides practitioners with tools and techniques they need to know now in order to be successful. The training includes a variety of proven approaches to help ensure that interfaces are effective, easy to learn, efficient, memorable, and satisfying.

Course Format

We offer a four course format that covers all aspects of UX - User Experience Foundation, User-Centered Analysis and Conceptual Design, The Science and Art of Effective Web and Application Design and Practical Usability Testing. The courses can be taken one at a time to fit your schedule or one per week in one month.

Instructors

Instructors are experienced and passionate about UX. They are active professionals who have extensive real-world experience across diverse industries. Their ability to connect course content with real-life examples makes the materials even more relevant.

Individual and Organization Level Training

Producing user-centered designs is important to everyone working on an interface, regardless of whether it's just one person or a few individuals handling usability tasks, or whether you have several large teams with specialized user experience (UX) functions. Following a user-centered design approach for products and services helps to increase an individual's or an organization's competitiveness in the marketplace.



UX Career Potential

What is the career development trajectory of UX professionals in the future?

The UX field is a great place to be working and promises tremendous growth opportunities. There is a huge demand for people who do this kind of work. With the right set of capabilities, this is one field that is really not threatened by automation trends like robotics.

How much does a UX Designer make – in different parts of the world?

As with any other industry, compensation packages vary according to your exact job title (UX Designer or UX Researcher or Information Architect or UX Writer, etc.), years of experience, UX skills and/or certification, location, etc.

Here's a quick look at what Coursera has summarized in its 2022 salary guide for various UX-related roles in the United States.

Job Title	Glassdoor	Robert Half
UX Designer	\$115,743	\$102,000
UI Designer	\$98,583	\$85,000
UX Researcher	\$128,682	\$92,250
Product Designer	\$105,448	\$85,000
Information Architect	\$113,758	\$101,000
UX Writer	\$103,053	Not listed
UX Engineer	\$110,607	Not listed

Average or median salary in the US in January 2022 by UX job title

Being User, an independent recruitment and staffing agency created a Salary report - India, with the data gathered from conversations with candidates, partner organizations and market insights.

Job Title	Experience	Minium	Average	Maximum
Entry Level UX designers	0-1 year	Rs 7,20,000	Rs 9,80,000	Rs 14,00,000
UX designer level 1	2 years	Rs 11,00,000	Rs 15,50,000	Rs 22,50,000
UX designer level 2	2-4 years	Rs 16,00,000	Rs 21,70,000	Rs 31,50,000
Senior UX designers	4-6 years	Rs 19,50,000	Rs 28,20,000	Rs 38,00,000
Lead UX designers	6-8 years	Rs 26,00,000	Rs 36,50,000	Rs 46,50,000
Principal UX manager	8+ years	Rs 38,00,000	Rs 45,00,000	Rs 52,00,000

Also check out the figures as stated by Career Foundry as salaries for UX Designers according to their location.

United States	US\$69,600 - US\$114,300
Canada	CA\$50,000 - CA\$101,800
Australia	AU\$59,500 - AU\$115,600
Germany	€34,500 - €70,000
China	¥126,000 - ¥297,000
United Kingdom	£30,600 - £65,700

Success Stories



Sandesh Subedi

Co-founder, ProCreator Design Studio, Mumbai

CUA™ helped me achieve my boyhood ambition of making a better world through design. I was always a design geek, but I felt that I lacked the tools to understand and articulate why certain things happen the way they do. Then I went on to do the CUA™ course from HFI. And my life changed. I believe that CUA™ has helped me become more empathetic and has made me an articulate designer, with a better structured and conscious awareness of the world around me.



Sujeesh Sukumaran

CUA™ helped me on my Robin Hood mission to build a healthier world. I was introduced to HFI by chance and now I use design science on a daily basis to help people collaborate and share ideas on healthy living. The CUA™ course helped me understand the psychology and science behind design, and gave me a set of UX and UI tools that I could use in a more systematic and less instinctive way. Through constant testing, experimentation and user validation, I feel that I am a more effective, persuasive and confident designer.



Evan Sunwall

It's interesting how some of the topics from my CXA™ have become very relevant now that I'm tasked with staffing and managing a design team. You begin to appreciate the importance of maintaining design standards, organizing an effective team structure, and having an executive champion with budgeting power.



No matter the location or the exact job title, UX Design is by far one of the fastest growing professions, offering advantages in terms of career growth, compensation, and sheer work excitement and satisfaction. The role was also included in Glassdoor's list of 25 Highest Paying Entry Level Jobs, coming in at number six. LinkedIn also listed UX design as one of 15 jobs on the rise in 2021.

With UX Designers so much in demand, what are you waiting for?
Get the skills you need to succeed in the UX field with HFI training and certification programs.

Questions? Write to programadvisor@humanfactors.com.

For more information on our certification and training tracks,
please visit our website www.humanfactors.com/training.aspx

